

FACT FILE

- » **When:** Early Cretaceous
- » **Length:** 23 ft (7 m)
- » **Fun fact:** Sauropelta had a horny beak instead of front teeth.

Sauropelta

A scary sight, Sauropelta was huge, heavy, and came complete with horn-covered plates. This ankylosaur had extra defensive weapons, including sharp spikes and spines on its shoulders.

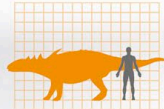


Bony studs provided a protective shield.

Sharp blades stood out on either side of the tail.

Spikes were largest and sharpest around the neck.

» Scale



Ankylosaurs

Ankylosaurs had the best protection of any dinosaur. Although they were slow-moving plant-eaters, their self-defense was full body armor. Bony plates that were fused, or joined, to the skin meant that the ankylosaurs, which means “fused lizard,” were the last meal choice for any hungry hunters.

Armored animals

Some of today's animals, such as turtles, crocodiles, and armadillos, also have special types of body armor. Pangolins are covered in hard, overlapping scales and can roll into a ball to protect their belly.



Pangolin